

Faculty of Computing & Information Technology
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Subject: Social Services

Topic: Drug Abuse in Pakistan

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Drug Abuse in Pakistan: Causes, Effects, and Solutions from an Islamic Perspective

1. Introduction

- **Definition of Drug Abuse:** The habitual use of substances that alter mental and physical health, leading to addiction and harm.
 - **Overview of the Issue in Pakistan:** According to the UNODC (United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime), Pakistan has around **6.7 million drug users**, with **4 million classified as addicts**.
 - **Islamic View on Intoxicants:** Islam strictly prohibits the consumption of intoxicants as they harm the body, mind, and soul. Allah says in the Qur'an: **"O you who have believed, indeed, intoxicants, gambling, [sacrificing on] stone alters [to other than Allah], and divining arrows are but defilement from the work of Satan, so avoid it that you may be successful."** (Surah Al-Ma'idah 5:90)
 - **Importance of Addressing Drug Abuse in Society:** Drug addiction destroys individuals and families, weakens the moral fabric of society, and distances people from faith and righteousness.
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2. Causes of Drug Abuse in Pakistan

1. **Easy Availability & Smuggling**
 - Pakistan's location near **Afghanistan**, the world's largest **opium** producer, makes drug trafficking easier.
 - Drugs like **heroin, hashish, and crystal meth** (ice) are easily accessible.
 - Islam teaches that **enabling or selling harmful substances is a sin**, and earning through such means is haram (forbidden). The Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said: **"When Allah forbids something, He also forbids its price."** (Sunan Abu Dawood 3488)
2. **Peer Pressure & Social Influence**
 - Many young people start using drugs due to peer pressure in **schools, colleges, and universities**.
 - Islam emphasizes the importance of **good companionship**. The Prophet (ﷺ) said: **"A person is likely to follow the faith of his friend, so look whom you befriend."** (Sunan Abu Dawood 4833)
3. **Mental Health Issues**
 - **Depression, anxiety, and emotional distress** lead many to use drugs as an escape.
 - Instead of turning to harmful substances, **Islam encourages prayer (Salah), remembrance of Allah (Dhikr), and reliance on Him**. **"Verily, in the remembrance of Allah do hearts find peace."** (Surah Ar-Ra'd 13:28)
4. **Unemployment & Poverty**

- Economic struggles force some individuals to turn to drugs.
 - Islam encourages **hard work, patience, and seeking halal (lawful) sustenance**.
"And whoever fears Allah – He will make for him a way out, and will provide for him from where he does not expect." (*Surah At-Talaq 65:2-3*)
5. **Lack of Awareness & Education**
- Many people do not understand the **harms of drug abuse**.
 - There is no proper **Islamic education** in many institutions regarding the dangers of intoxicants.
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3. Commonly Abused Drugs in Pakistan

- **Heroin** – Most commonly used drug.
- **Hashish (Charas)** – Popular among young people.
- **Opium (Afeem)** – Traditional use in some rural areas.
- **Crystal Meth (Ice)** – Gaining popularity among students.
- **Cocaine & Ecstasy** – Used in elite parties.
- **Prescription Drugs (Sleeping pills, painkillers)** – Often misused.

Islam **prohibits all intoxicants**, as even small amounts lead to addiction. The Prophet (ﷺ) said:

"Whatever intoxicates in large amounts, a small amount of it is also forbidden." (*Sunan Ibn Majah 3392*)

4. Effects of Drug Abuse

A. Health Consequences

- Damage to the **brain, liver, and heart**.
- Increased risk of **HIV/AIDS and Hepatitis C** due to shared needles.
- Mental disorders such as **paranoia, schizophrenia, and depression**.

B. Social Consequences

- **Breakdown of family relationships** and increase in domestic violence.
- **Increase in crime rates** (theft, violence, and gang activity).
- **Decreased productivity** in workplaces and educational institutions.

C. Economic Consequences

- The **government spends millions** on rehabilitation centers and law enforcement.
- **Addicts become dependent** and are unable to contribute to the economy.

Islam considers **the body a trust (Amanah) from Allah**, and one must protect it. The Prophet (ﷺ) said:
"**Your body has a right over you.**" (*Sahih Bukhari 5199*)

5. Government & Social Efforts to Control Drug Abuse

A. Anti-Narcotics Force (ANF) & Laws

- **The Control of Narcotic Substances Act (CNSA) 1997** imposes strict punishments on drug trafficking.
- **The Anti-Narcotics Force (ANF)** actively cracks down on drug suppliers.

B. Rehabilitation Centers

- Government and private organizations run **drug rehabilitation centers** in cities like **Lahore, Karachi, and Islamabad**.
- Free treatment is provided in some government-run centers.

C. Awareness Campaigns

- NGOs like **Aghosh, Dost Welfare Foundation, and Nai Zindagi** work to educate the public.
 - Schools and colleges are conducting **awareness sessions** to prevent drug use.
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6. Role of Society in Combating Drug Abuse

1. Parents & Families

- **Monitor children's behavior and friends** to prevent bad influences.
- **Teach Islamic values** and the harms of drug use from a young age.

2. Educational Institutions

- Schools should **introduce drug awareness programs** based on Islamic teachings.
- Teachers should **identify students struggling with substance abuse** and offer help.

3. Media & Influencers

- **Social media, TV, and newspapers** should promote **anti-drug campaigns**.
- Celebrities and influencers should **encourage a healthy, faith-driven lifestyle**.

4. Religious & Community Leaders

- **Imams and scholars** should emphasize the **prohibition of drugs in Islam**.

- **Mosques should organize workshops** to educate the youth.
- **Encourage youth to engage in religious, sports, and community activities** instead of drug use.

Allah warns against harming oneself:

"And do not throw [yourselves] into destruction with your own hands." (*Surah Al-Baqarah 2:195*)

7. Conclusion

- Drug abuse is a **serious issue** affecting **individuals, families, and society**.
- **Islam provides guidance** by strictly prohibiting intoxicants and promoting a **healthy, faith-based lifestyle**.
- **Strong laws, awareness, and rehabilitation programs** are needed.
- **Everyone (government, parents, teachers, and society) must work together** to eliminate drug abuse.
- **Faith, education, and community support** are key solutions.

"Say No to Drugs – A Step Towards a Healthier Pakistan and a Path Closer to Allah!"